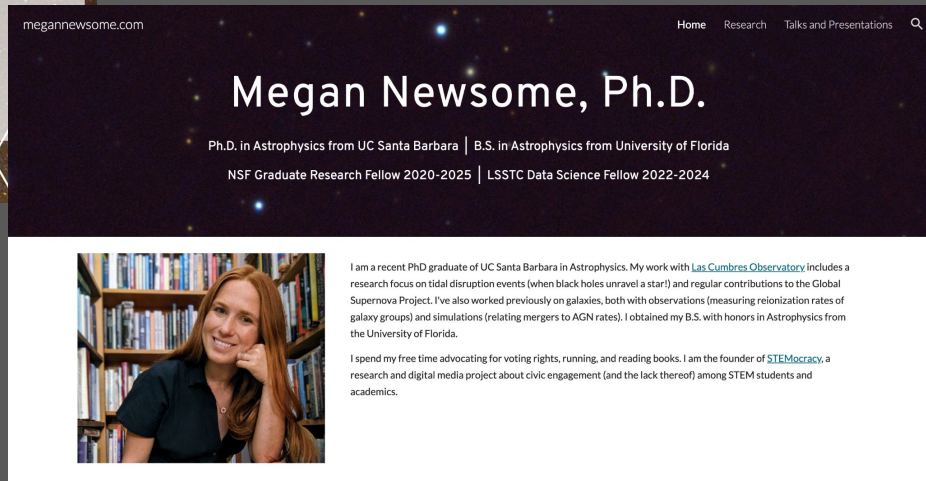
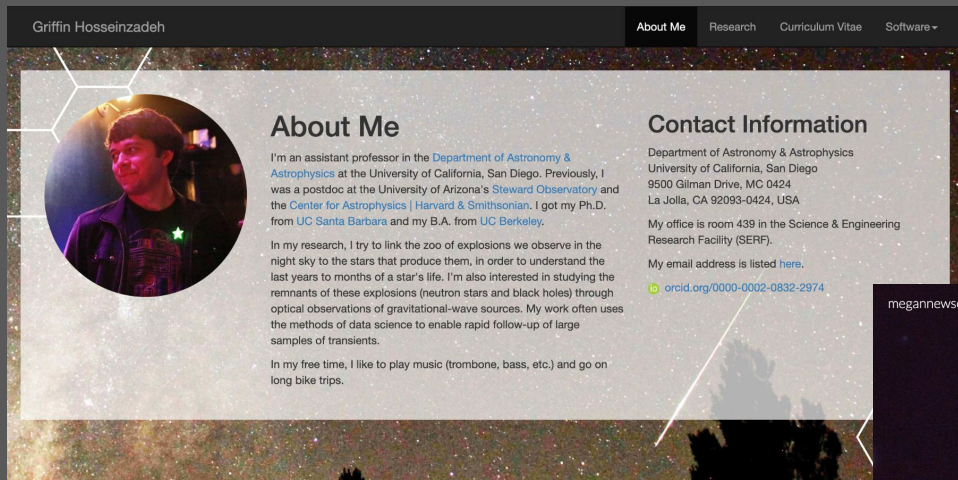


Making a Project Website:

Instructions for Github & Google Sites



Why use Github for a personal-professional website?

1. Access to thousands of free templates
2. More customizability by adjusting backend code manually
3. Kind of the “norm” in astronomy

Why use anything else?

1. Uninterested in backend development; fine with using a limited template without adjusting it too much
2. Less backend development → more user friendly
3. You already have something established

How to use Github Pages for websites:

<https://pages.github.com>*

1

Create a repository

Head over to [GitHub](#) and [create a new public repository](#) named `username.github.io`, where `username` is your username (or organization name) on GitHub.

If the first part of the repository doesn't exactly match your username, it won't work, so make sure to get it right.

Create a new repository

A repository contains all project files, including the revision history.

Owner

 sophshep ▾

Repository name *

sopshep.github.io ✓

Great repository names are short and memorable. Need inspiration? How about **fictional-winner**?

Description (optional)

☒  **Public**

Anyone can see this repository. You choose who can commit.

☐  **Private**

You choose who can see and commit to this repository.

☐ **Initialize this repository with a README**

This will let you immediately clone the repository to your computer. Skip this step if you're importing an existing repository.

Add .gitignore: **None** ▾

Add a license: **None** ▾ ⓘ

Create repository

*Many other items on this page are outdated, so follow this tutorial more than this link

How to use Github Pages for a project page

You get one main site: `username.github.io` . Create a repo with that name, enable GitHub Pages, and the content in that repo will be hosted on that domain.

For any of your public repos, if you enable GitHub Pages, that content will live at `username.github.io/project` . Same features as the main one, just living at that URL. You can have as many public repos as you want with pages enabled.

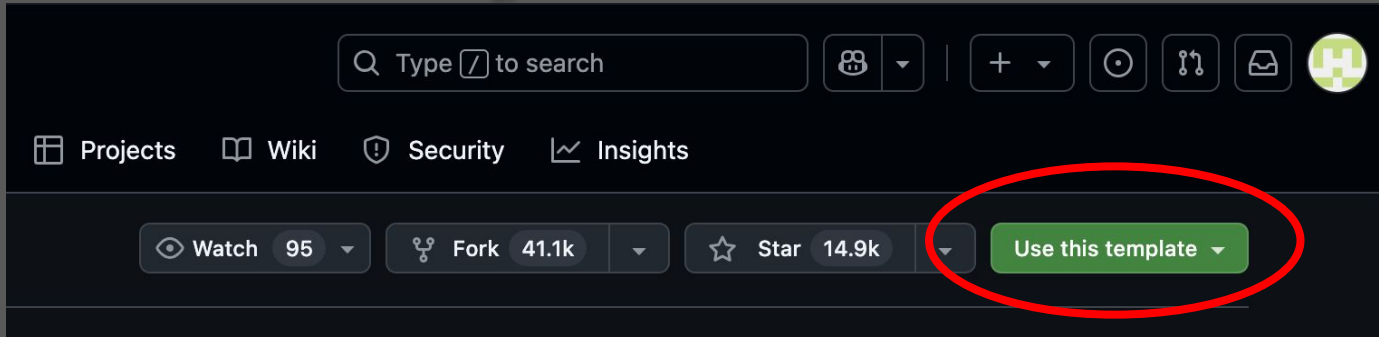
Yes, this means you don't need to have anything set up for the main site in order to host a project.

How to use Github Pages for a project page

1. On Github, create repo that is called `<your_username>.github.io` and enable Github Pages. This will be your main user site. *It does not need to have anything, besides the README prompted when you enable Github Pages, for the next steps.*
2. Find a template you like for your *project webpage* (do not worry about your “main user site” for now) at <https://github.com/topics/jekyll-theme>
 - a. I highly recommend everyone choose the first option, “AcademicPages,” so instructions stay relevant and uniform
 - b. If you choose another template, that’s fine, but you’re on your own!

How to use Github Pages for a project page

3. Whatever template you choose, when you click its Github link, make sure it has this green button available:



4. Click this button. It will basically fork the repository into your own Github. You will then rename this repository:
`<your_username>.github.io/<your_project_name>`

How to use Github Pages for a project page

5. From here, read the documentation on the template's Github page, and/or any Wiki material they might have.
 - a. If you want to work on your website locally (to test changes without them going live on the real website), you will need to git clone your project repository in the terminal, and you may need to make some additional installations in your terminal based on the documentation.
 - b. Read more for the template I recommended at:
<https://academicpages.github.io>
6. Now edit the appropriate files in the template! Suggested edits include:
 - a. Changing _config.yml to personalize content
 - b. Changing _config.yml to turn off all the other pages (we just want all the content for our project on the "home" page)

How to use Github Pages for a project page

```
24  _config.yml  View

@@ -7,13 +7,13 @@

# Site Settings
locale      : "en-US"
- title     : "Your Name / Site Title"
+ title     : "Dr. Test Account"
title_separator : "-"
- name      : &name "Your Name"
- description : &description "personal description"
- url       : https://academicpages.github.io # the base hostname & protocol for your site
+ name      : &name "Dr. Test Account"
+ description : &description "Research scientist at Test University"
+ url       : https://getorg-testacct.github.io # the base hostname & protocol for your site
baseurl     : "" # the subpath of your site, e.g. "/blog"
- repository : "academicpages/academicpages.github.io"
+ repository : "getorg-testacct.github.io"
```

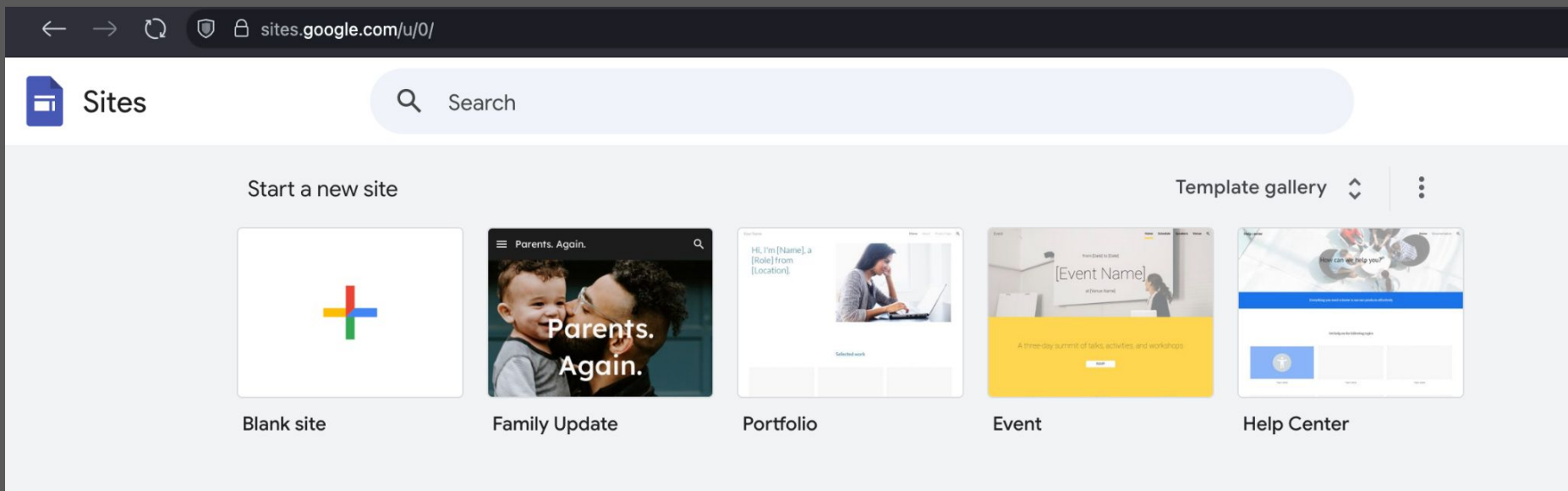
Try changing the “true” to “false” for the collections used by the template - what changes on the website?

```
academicpages.github.io / _config.yml
Blame 356 lines (322 loc) · 9.81 KB

entity_output: as_char
toc_levels: 1..6
smart_quotes: lsquo,rsquo,ldquo,rdquo
enable_coderay: false

# These settings control the types of collections used by the template
collections:
  teaching:
    output: true
    permalink: /:collection/:path/
  publications:
    output: true
    permalink: /:collection/:path/
  portfolio:
    output: true
    permalink: /:collection/:path/
  talks:
    output: true
    permalink: /:collection/:path/
```


I don't want to be a web developer! I want a visual template! Why aren't we sponsored by Squarespace?!



Luckily, it really is as easy as going to sites.google.com and choosing whichever one you want.

Most important elements of a personal-professional website:

1. Informative home page: your other pages will have more detailed content, but the first thing people say when they google your-name-dot-com shouldn't be a blank page!
 - a. Pictures of yourself are common but not at all necessary
 - b. Pictures of your research directing people to other tabs on your site are also good
 - c. Footer should give clear links to relevant professional sites like your Github & your LinkedIn
2. "About" page - actually not necessary, but good to have if your home page doesn't say much about you.
3. "Research" page - if you're making this site for professional purposes, this is the most important page.
 - a. If/when you have them, Publications can be listed on this page
 - b. Eventually good to have a distinct link for Publications that takes people to your ADS summary
4. CV - this can be a link to a PDF or a web-formatted version of your CV
5. A page for your next-strongest academic-related activity: Giving talks/presentations; doing outreach; teaching classes are all good options.